

To read the `NEXT_LOCALE` cookie value in JavaScript, you can use built-in browser properties for client-side scripts or specialized Next.js functions for server-side code.

Client-Side (Standard JavaScript)

You can access the cookie through [document.cookie](#), which returns a string containing all available cookies. To extract a specific value like `NEXT_LOCALE`, use a helper function:  MDN Web Docs +2

javascript



```
function getNextLocale() {
  const name = "NEXT_LOCALE=";
  const decodedCookie = decodeURIComponent(document.cookie);
  const ca = decodedCookie.split(';');
  for(let i = 0; i < ca.length; i++) {
    let c = ca[i].trim();
    if (c.indexOf(name) === 0) {
      return c.substring(name.length, c.length);
    }
  }
  return "";
}

console.log(getNextLocale()); // Outputs the locale, e.g., "en" or "fr"
```

Note: If the cookie is marked as `HttpOnly`, it cannot be accessed via client-side JavaScript.  DEV Community

Server-Side (Next.js App Router)

In Next.js Server Components or API Routes, use the [cookies\(\)](#) function from `next/headers`.  Next.js +1

javascript



```
import { cookies } from 'next/headers';

export default async function Page() {
  const cookieStore = await cookies();
  const nextLocale = cookieStore.get('NEXT_LOCALE')?.value;

  return <div>Current Locale: {nextLocale}</div>;
}
```

Using Libraries

For a more robust solution in the browser, popular libraries like js-cookie simplify the syntax:  Stack Overflow +1

javascript



```
import Cookies from 'js-cookie';  
  
const locale = Cookies.get('NEXT_LOCALE');
```

Key Considerations

- **Next.js Behavior:** The `NEXT_LOCALE` cookie is primarily used by Next.js to override automatic language detection when a user hits the root path (/).
- **Security:** Always check if your application sets cookies with the `HttpOnly` flag, as this will prevent `document.cookie` from "seeing" them.  Stack Overflow +3